



**Manchester
Metropolitan
University**

**Careers
Service**

Career Choices, Planning and Goalsetting

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Visit mmu.ac.uk/careers



Today we will...

- Start to think about the idea of career planning and goalsetting, including Future Me Plan
- Talk about skills. What are they? Why are they important?
- Think about your motivations, values & preferences – how do these impact your career choices?
- Think about the tasks that you need to complete



Things That Influence Career Choice

Motivations, Values and
Preferences

What are your values?



Aim is to start thinking about your personality, motivations, values & preferences in the context of your career



We will also start thinking about the skills that you prefer employing, and your strengths and weaknesses



Think about these in the context of university study or work

Preferences

“I’m really good at.....”

Examples – teaching things to other people, working as a team, working with numbers, doing practical work, using IT, being creative, managing people, public speaking, leading a team

“I absolutely love to.....”

Examples – help people, solve problems, produce new ideas, work with lots of data, work alone, follow processes

“When it comes down to it, what really matters to me is....”

Examples – doing a job that helps people’s lives, being part of a new data analysis development, being in a job where I can be ambitious and a leader in my field, earning a high salary, being in a job where I can travel as part of work, being in a role where I can work at home

“I do my best work when.....”

Examples – I work at a fast pace to specific deadlines, I’m interested in my work, I can share ideas with other people, I can get support from others, I’m interested in what I’m working on, I work alone



Motivations & career planning

What drives you? What makes you get out of bed in the morning?



Values- what's important to you? What are your personal ethics?

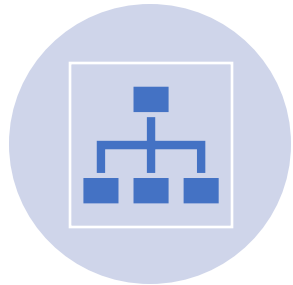


What do you care about? What are you passionate about?

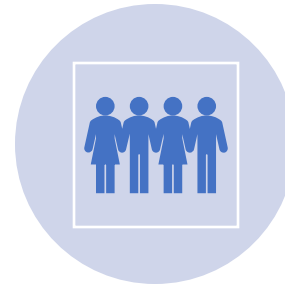


Preferences- what work conditions suit your personality?

How do you know what a company's values are?



Every company will have a set of 'values' or 'ethics'



This is the culture they hope to achieve in their workplace



A compass guiding what they do, why they do it and how they do it



Can usually find it on their website

Skills



Transferable Skills from Mathematics



Numeracy



Analysis and
interpretation of
data



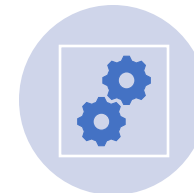
Examination of
metrics



Logical thinking



Problem solving



Technical
thinking



Reasoning

Transferable Skills from Mathematics



Research
capabilities



Teamwork



Written and
verbal
communication



Presentational
skills



Commercial
awareness



Business
acumen



Initiative

Skills from Other Experience



Part-time jobs



Jobs4Students:
Student
ambassador or
other work



Mentor schemes



Volunteering or
community work



Charitable
fundraising work



Clubs & societies



Extra-curricular
interests and
achievements

Studying mathematics opens up careers in a range of sectors such as IT, finance, engineering, space science and teaching

Job options

Jobs directly related to your degree include:

- Academic researcher
- Acoustic consultant
- Actuary
- Astronomer
- Data analyst
- Data scientist
- Investment analyst
- Operational researcher
- Private tutor
- Research scientist (maths)
- Secondary school teacher
- Software engineer
- Statistician

Jobs where your degree would be useful include:

- Business analyst
- Chartered accountant
- Chartered certified accountant
- Economist



Mathematics- Career Choices



Chartered accountancy



Actuary



Data analyst



Data scientist



Financial/investment/business intelligence analyst



Statistician



Researcher



Software engineer

Mathematics- Career Choices

 Operational researcher Secondary school teacher Financial trader Quantity surveyor Machine learning engineer Computer programmer IT consultant Civil Service fast stream

Planning and Goalsetting





Future Me Plan

[Future me | Manchester Metropolitan University \(mmu.ac.uk\)](https://mmu.ac.uk/futureme)

The Four Stages

There are four stages in each Future Me Plan cycle.

Map- plan your journey and set short or long-term goals.

Experience- try a range of different experiences

Reflect- consider how your experiences have shaped your thinking

Share- curate your story and share with others



Benefits of a Future Me Plan

- It helps to create **focus** on what your **priorities** are
- It helps you **say no** to things that won't help you reach your goals
- It shows you where you need to change things, what's possible etc.... so you don't end up overwhelmed and unable to achieve it all
- It gives you **motivation** to get where you want to go.
- It helps you **track** each year whether you are on course, whether things need to change to another course – and you can take control properly
- You're **more likely to achieve** what you want if you are planning to get there...





Goalsetting- Set the Goals

Long-term aims

Short-term goals

SMART

SMART GOALS

SPECIFIC – What do you want to achieve and by when?



MEASURABLE – How will you know you have achieved your goal?



ACHIEVABLE – What are the actions or tasks needed to achieve success?



REALISTIC – Is it likely you can achieve this goal in the timeframe specified?



TIMELY – Give yourself a deadline

SMART GOALS

- **RESEARCH** the options available to you relating to your first degree and PG study
- **EXPLORE** career options and the actions involved in achieving your goal(s)
- **FOCUS** on identifying means to gain experience
- **IDENTIFY** opportunities you wish to apply to

Example of SMART goals (short)

“I will connect with 15 people on Linked In by the end of term in companies that I’m interested in working for”

“I will attend 5 careers events this year”

“I will write 3 questions before each careers event I attend and ensure I ask them to at least 5 different employers to boost my networking skills”

“I will update my CV and send it to the Careers Service’s Ask a Question system to review it by December”

“I will gain work experience in accounting & finance by the start of my second year”

Example of SMART goals (longer)

“I will work in data or metrics analysis within 2 years of graduating”

“I will work abroad for at least 6 months in a role related to IT”

“I will complete a postgrad in Secondary Mathematics with QTS and work within a secondary school within 5 years ”

Personal SWOT Analysis



Bring Clarity and
Direction to Your Career

Strengths What do you do well?

Weaknesses What could you improve?

Opportunities What opportunities are open to you?

Threats What threats could harm you?



Personal SWOT Analysis Tips

Strengths

- What advantages do you have that others don't have (for example, skills, certifications, education, or connections)?
- Which of your **achievements** are you most proud of?
- What **values** do you believe in that others fail to exhibit?

Weaknesses

- Are you completely **confident in your education and skills training**? If not, where are you weakest?
- **What tasks do you usually avoid** because you don't feel confident doing them?
- **Do you have personality traits that hold you back in your field?** For instance, if you have to conduct meetings on a regular basis, a fear of public speaking would be a major weakness.

Personal SWOT Analysis Tips

Opportunities

- Do you have a professional network to help you, or offer good advice?
- Are you using social media to be kept up to date of sector/company news/opportunities?
- Are you tapping into the hidden job market as well as applying to advertised opportunities?

Threats

- What obstacles/challenges do you currently face with your job search/career goals?
- Are your peers competing for the same opportunities?
- Could any of your weaknesses lead to threats?

Goalsetting- Answer the Questions

What do you expect to achieve from your course?

Do you have personal development aims? What are they?

Do you have a specific career in mind? If so, what is it?

Are there any university or wider social issues you are passionate about and would like to get involved with? If so, what are they?

Where do you see yourself in five years' time?

Are there any attributes you would like to develop? If so, which ones and why? How do they contribute to your overall career goal?

Useful Resources

[How to Make the Most of Your Time at Manchester Metropolitan University](#)

[Researching Your Career Options](#)

[Prospective Employers](#)

[Career Centre Topic: Planning](#)

[Career Centre Topic: Values](#)

[Career Centre Learning Path: Recognising Skills and Preferences](#)





Faculty of

Science and Engineering

Week 6: Get set for success

Monday 3 November - Friday 7 November

mmu.ac.uk/week6

SCAN ME!



**Careers
Service**

Graduate Jobs and Placements Fair



Business School and Dalton building



mmu.ac.uk/graduate-jobs-and-placements-fair

5 November





Thank You For Listening!

Any questions!!!